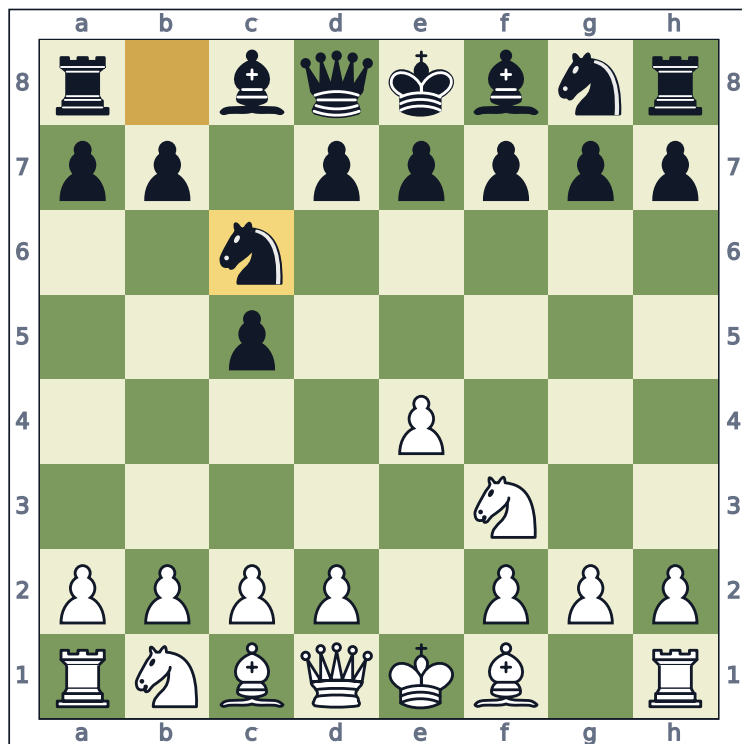


SICILIAN DEFENSE

Sicilian Defense

ECO B30 | 9 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.61 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Unbalanced and ambitious: both sides usually receive active plans and real winning chances.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

B30 covers Sicilian Defense. Black answers 1.e4 with ...c5, creating an asymmetrical center and immediate long-term counterplay. The diagram uses the featured line Sicilian Defense: Old Sicilian.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Develop rapidly, use d4 when appropriate, exploit central space, and decide whether play belongs on the kingside or in the center.

BLACK'S GOALS

Use the half-open c-file, pressure the center, prepare ...d5 or ...e5, and generate queenside or central counterplay.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

...d5 is often Black's equalizing break. White commonly uses e5, f4-f5, or a central sacrifice to open lines.

PIECE MAP

The c-file, d5 square, and development race are central. In opposite-side castling, every tempo matters. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Memorized attacks fail when the center or castling pattern differs by one move. Recalculate before launching pawns. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: Black pawn on c5, White pawn on e4.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

A first-rate fighting defense with enormous depth. It is excellent, but specialized variations can be theory-heavy.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named B30 line

This section preserves all 9 names and defining routes assigned to B30 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Sicilian Defense: Closed, Anti-Sveshnikov Variation

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 e5

002 Sicilian Defense: Closed, Anti-Sveshnikov Variation, Kharlov-Kramnik Line

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 e5 4. Bc4 Be7 5. d3 d6 6. Nd2 Bg5

003 Sicilian Defense: Closed, Anti-Sveshnikov Variation, with Nf6

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 e5 4. Bc4 Be7 5. d3 Nf6

004 Sicilian Defense: Closed, Anti-Sveshnikov Variation, with d6

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 e5 4. Bc4 Be7 5. d3 d6

005 Sicilian Defense: Nyezhmetdinov-Rossolimo Attack

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5

006 Sicilian Defense: Nyezhmetdinov-Rossolimo Attack, Brooklyn Retreat Defense

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 Nb8

007 Sicilian Defense: Nyezhmetdinov-Rossolimo Attack, San Francisco Gambit

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 Na5 4. b4

008 Sicilian Defense: Old Sicilian

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6

009 Sicilian Defense: Portsmouth Gambit

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. b4